

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

A world map with dashed blue lines representing diaspora routes. The lines originate from various points across the globe, including North America, Europe, Africa, and Asia, and converge towards a central point in East Asia, specifically China. The map includes labels for major bodies of water like the North Atlantic Ocean, Indian Ocean, and North Pacific Ocean, as well as several countries such as the United States, Mexico, Venezuela, Bolivia, Nigeria, Kenya, Tanzania, India, China, and Mongolia.

DIASPORA - 1

MODULE - 54

UNDERSTANDING DIASPORA

- 1** The term diaspora is derived from the Greek word diaspeirein, which means dispersion.
- 2** Over the years, the term evolved and now refers to any person/s belonging to a particular country with a common origin or culture, residing outside their homeland for various reasons.
- 3** Diaspora is not homogenous since migration involves human mobility over multiple time periods.
- 4** The diaspora covers practically every part of the world.



INDIAN DIASPORA

- 1 It began during the British rule as indentured labourers to former colonies like Fiji, Kenya and Malaysia.
- 2 It also refers to their descendants.
- 3 Indian diaspora is getting influential across the world leading to hundreds of people of Indian origin holding various positions as heads in states and governments, senators, members of parliament, to name a few.
- 4 Indian diaspora has been varied since colonial times to the early years of independence and immediately on to the present.



INDIAN DIASPORA

5 It continued in the post-independence period with Indians moving to United Kingdom, the United States and the Gulf countries.

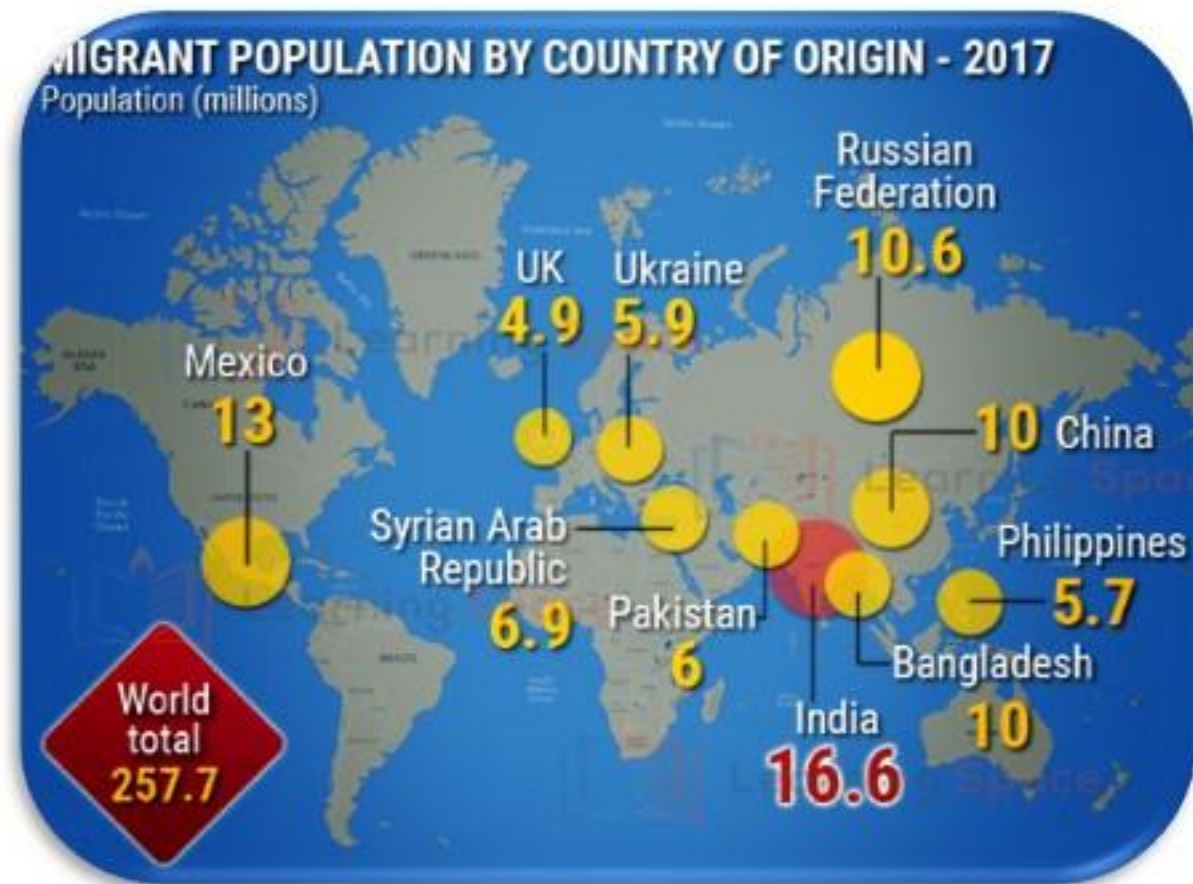
6 Today the diaspora from Gulf, look for India for support on welfare issues.

7 It has served as a powerful 'soft power' tool in the hands of Indian policy makers with respect to South-east Asia.



INDIAN DIASPORA

- 8 The diaspora has contributed through FDI, remittances and transfer of knowledge and entrepreneurial means but also through the rise of service sector in India.
- 9 The diaspora also contributes to India's soft power independent of government policy.
- 10 The government has also urged the diaspora members to invest in social projects such as improving rural sanitation and visiting India every year to boost tourism.



IMPORTANCE OF A STRONG DIASPORA

- 1 Diaspora is a source of nation building and soft power.
- 2 Diaspora as a source of inflow of foreign capital and investments.
- 3 Diaspora acts as a facilitator in accessing technological know-how and innovations. They help in bringing these technology and innovations to their country of origin through investments and collaborations.
- 4 Diaspora as facilitator in spread of indigenous culture and tradition.



IMPORTANCE OF A STRONG DIASPORA

5 Diaspora plays an important role in influencing policies and politics of its host country in favour of its country of origin.

6 Diaspora is becoming prominent with getting prominent places in the high offices of the residing nations which helps further in building economic linkages.



ECONOMIC SUPPORT FOR INDIA

1 In the age of economic slowdown and inflationary pressures, Indian government has great expectations from millions of Non-resident Indians to resolve the crisis by investing in India.

2 Though India has enough natural resources, it does not have enough capital to exploit them

3 NRIs and PIOs generate a lot of income.

\$131 BILLION ESTIMATED TO FLOW TO INDIA & CHINA

Falling Rupee Helps India Stay On Top

Migrants are expected to send \$414 billion in remittances home this year to developing countries, and the figure is likely rise to \$540 billion by 2016. That makes remittance funds almost four times more important to developing nations than official foreign aid from governments, which the United Nations says amounts to about \$126 billion a year. The current global total of remittances to all nations is \$549 billion. As in the past years, India remains the biggest benefactor.

Top Recipients of Officially Recorded Remittances Are...



IN INDIA, remittances are larger than the earnings from IT exports. With the weakening of the rupee, a surge in remittances is expected as NRIs take advantage of the cheaper goods, services and assets back home.

\$700 b
Estimated Worldwide Flow by 2016

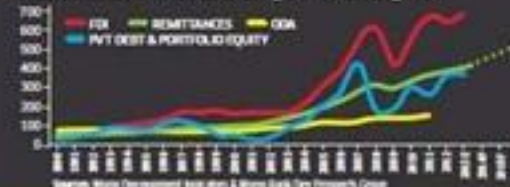
\$549 b
The current global total of remittances to all nations

232 m
Total global migrants in 2013, up from 175m in 2000

Remittances Tend to Rise When The Currency Falls



Remittance Flows are Large & Growing as well



Remittance Costs Remain High in Many Regions



ECONOMIC SUPPORT FOR INDIA

- 4 Thus, they can contribute a lot to the Indian economy and enhance its fiscal growth.
- 5 For diaspora diplomacy, India needs to share good relations with that country.
- 6 Persons of Indian Origin (PIOs) can help India by investing in Indian industry and infrastructure to encourage its economic growth.
- 7 The NRIs help in developmental, social, educational and other welfare projects



ROLE IN FOREIGN POLICY

- 1 Indian diaspora has also emerged as an important factor in India's foreign policy, economic development and knowledge transfer.
- 2 With \$56 billion of remittances, overseas Indians play an important role in India's foreign exchange management.
- 3 Remittances aid in socio-economic development as it used for the recipient family's personal use, in temple building and for donations to schools. These remittances have played a role in poverty reduction
- 4 Medical tourism and travel are one of the biggest beneficiaries.
- 5 Technology transfer can help countries mutually.
- 6 Sports can act as a common area of collaboration with countries like Kenya, South Africa, etc.



ADVANCEMENT IN SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

1 The diaspora's scientific achievements and professionals in the domain of medicine and academia have encouraged India's presence in the world.

2 The most visible is India's IT sector and its symbolic relationship with the Silicon Valley in California.

3 A long-term advantage is nurturing ties with an active diaspora is an accelerated technological sector and increased socio-economic development.

4 Bengaluru, Gurugram and Hyderabad are examples of this development



SUPPORT FOR INDIA'S FUTURE

- 1 Diaspora can play an important role in India's quest to be a knowledge power and a developed country.
- 2 By sharing and re-sharing vital information on affected regions and people, supplies and precautionary measures.
- 3 The linking of social capital between diaspora, civil society organisations, advocacy groups and government institutions, although necessary during rehabilitation is bound to lead to unanticipated and undesirable outcomes.

- 4 India can help its diaspora in other countries in health and education with its remarkable improvement.



DIASPORA IN THE GULF

- 1 India's diaspora in the Gulf, numbering between around 7 and 8 million has always been important to the country's economy and its policy objective of alleviating poverty.
- 2 The Gulf is India's main source of expat remittances.
- 3 The diaspora builds upon, cements and acts as a reminder to the public in Middle Eastern countries of the historical and cultural links between the two regions

Home away from home: Where Indians go

Rank	Country	No of Indians (in million)	% of total Indian diaspora
1	UAE	3.5	22.4
2	US	2.0	12.8
3	Saudi Arabia	1.9	12.1
4	Kuwait	1.0	6.4
5	Oman	0.7	4.5
6	UK	0.7	4.5
7	Qatar	0.6	3.8

Total
15.6
million

DIASPORA IN THE GULF

- 4 Members of the diaspora have an in-depth understanding of both cultures.
- 5 The scale of emigration to the Gulf is resulting in increased cultural exchange with Keralites.
- 6 The current Prime Minister has increased his visits to foreign countries and strengthened the role and significance of Indian diasporic community and stressed upon India's intellectual power from 'brain drain' to 'brain gain'.



GOVERNMENT INITIATIVES

- India has simplified the visa regime and merged the PIO and OCI into a single identity card to secure lifelong Indian visas.
- The diaspora is currently estimated to over twenty million and consists of three categories of overseas Indians:

- 1 NRI:** Non-Resident Indians are Indian citizens staying abroad for indefinite period (majority in gulf).
- 2 PIO:** Persons of Indian Origin who have acquired citizenship of other country.
- 3 SPIO:** Stateless Persons of Indian Origin who have no documents to substantiate their Indian origin.

BENEFITS OF BEING AN NRI

OVERSEAS ACCOUNTS



RFC, FCNR, NRE, NRO.

ELECTION



EDUCATION SYSTEM



SPECIAL RESERVATION QUOTA

GOVERNMENT INITIATIVES

1 The Government of India has taken several initiatives for **engaging the Indian diaspora** around the world.

2 At the same time, they create policies to encourage the diaspora to **contribute to India's growth** through philanthropy, knowledge transfers, investment in innovation and assistance in other development projects.

3 For example, the **2014 Minimum Referral Wages (MRW)** applicable only to Emigration Check Required (ECR) countries.

A PERSON OF INDIAN ORIGIN (PIO)	PIO VS OCI	OVERSEAS CITIZEN OF INDIA (OCI)
➤ Means a foreign citizen (except a national of Pakistan, Afghanistan, Bangladesh, China, Iran, Bhutan, Sri Lanka and Nepal) ➤ A foreign citizen whose one of the parents/ grandparents/ great grandparents was born and a permanent resident of India ➤ Who is a spouse of a citizen of India or a PIO		A foreign national, who was eligible to become citizen of India on 26.01.1950 or was a citizen of India on or at anytime after 26.01.1950 or belonged to a territory that became part of India after 15.08.1947 is eligible for registration as Overseas Citizen of India (OCI). Minor children of such person are also eligible for OCI. However, if the applicant had ever been a citizen of Pakistan or Bangladesh, he/she will not be eligible for OCI.
BENEFITS		BENEFITS
1. PIO card holders do not require a visa to visit India for a period of 15 years from the date of issue of the PIO card. 2. They are exempted from registration at FRRO/ FRO if their stay does not exceeds 180 days. In case if the stay exceeds 180 days, they shall have to register with FRRO/ FRO within the next 30 days 3. They enjoy parity with NRIs in economic, financial and educational benefits 4. All future benefits that would be exempted to NRIs would also be available to the PIO card holders		OCIs are entitled to a multipurpose, multiple entry, lifelong visa allowing them to visit India at any time, for any length of time and for any purpose ➤ Exempted from police reporting for any length of stay in the country ➤ Have also been granted all rights in the economic, financial and education fields in parity with NRIs except, the right to acquisition of agricultural or plantation properties

INDIA'S LARGE DIASPORA

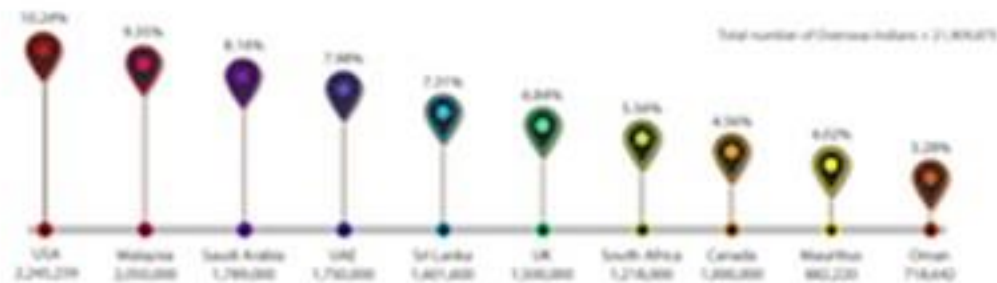
1 India benefiting from its Diaspora India has a large pool of professionals working in several countries across the world, helping India economically, diplomatically and culturally.

2 The impressive diaspora has played an important role in promoting India's interest abroad and act as its unnamed ambassadors.

3 There are several in the fields of culture, education, information technology, economic development and health and arts



INDIANS SETTLED ABROAD - TOP 10 COUNTRIES



GLOBAL PRESENCE OF INDIAN DIASPORA

- 1** In recent times, the government has laid down a strong foundation by making diplomacy people-centric with government's constant interaction with Indian diaspora.
- 2** The idea is to 'break barriers' that may have existed due to lack of communication between India and any other country.
- 3** India's permanent membership to the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) can become a reality with support from the diaspora.
- 4** India has demonstrated its diplomatic influence with the reappointment of Justice Dalveer Bhandari to the International Court of Justice in November 2017.
- 5** India can leverage its diaspora to influence states such as Canada and Mexico to support India's membership



PROGRAMS FOR INDIAN DIASPORA

1 In 2015, the Ministry of External Affairs launched the e-migrate system that requires all foreign employees to register in the database.

2 The Overseas Indian Affairs Ministry organises several programs to engage the Diaspora.

1. Pravasi Bhartiya Divas
2. Regional Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (RPBD)
3. Know India Program
4. Study India Program
5. Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) Card Scheme charitable work



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